

Using Wireless & Wired Network Adapters and (Broadband) Modems with Linux

Wireless card support in Linux is generally good. Standard desktop PCI based WiFi adapters will work out of the box without any need to install a driver. WiFi adapters that work out of the box include Broadcom, TP-Link and ASUS. For more information on Wireless compatibility under Linux, see [the Linux Wireless LAN](#) wiki. Some vendors have made cheaper soft-pci, mini-pci 'wintel' based adapters which are proprietary in nature and won't work out of the box. This can usually be resolved by loading a Windows driver inside Linux, using a tool called [ndiswrapper](#) ([see this wikipedia link for further information](#)).

Almost every wired network adapter available should be quite happy with Linux. Modern PCI or integrated based options such as those manufactured by Intel and Realtek range will automatically plug and play.

Internet routers or ADSL & Cable modems are usually one of two breeds, either they either plug into the USB port of your computer directly or they are fully blown Ethernet routers, today these mostly contain WiFi radio as well. Thankfully, most ISPs are now providing 'proper' Ethernet based routers which simply plug and play with Linux either over WiFi or via an Ethernet cable. If you do have a USB modem from your ISP, consider shelling out for a proper router as the USB modems support under Linux is somewhat hit-or-miss and you will often find that performance from a USB modem is less than you would get from a router (regardless of whether you are using Windows, Linux or a Mac). Good examples of external routers are Belkin, Netgear, Linksys, Huawei and Draytek.